



tips & tricks

To get an idea of the filetypes that you can use with kind, open Macintosh HD/System/Library/Frameworks/CoreServices.framework/Versions/A/Frameworks/Metadata.framework/Versions/A/Resources/English.lproj/MDPredicateKeywords.plist in a text editor of your choice.

To find out which hints you might be able to use, open Macintosh HD/System/Library/Frameworks/CoreServices.framework/Versions/A/Frameworks/Metadata.framework/Versions/A/Resources/English.lproj/schema.strings in a text editor, and scroll to the bottom.

Terminal tweaks

Because your Mac is a BSD-based system, you have all that Unix-y goodness at your fingertips — it would be a shame to waste all that. To get into the terminal, open Spotlight ([Cmd] + [Space]), type terminal and hit [Enter].

Monitor your processes

To see how much of your CPU your processes are hogging, you can use the Unix top command to see what they're up to. In the Terminal, type top, and you'll see a list of all running processes, ordered by how much of your CPU they're using. To stop watching the processes, press [Control] + [C].

If you find a process that's taking up more CPU time than it should, note down its process ID (in the first column), end top, and in the prompt, type kill [process ID].

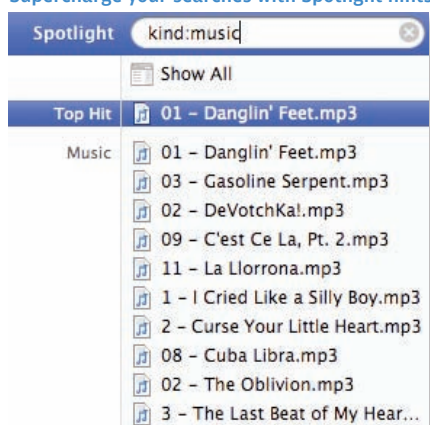
Change where screenshots get saved

Like us, you probably find it extremely irritating that screenshots get saved on the desktop — no save dialog, nothing. Thankfully, changing the default location for screenshots is just a terminal command away.

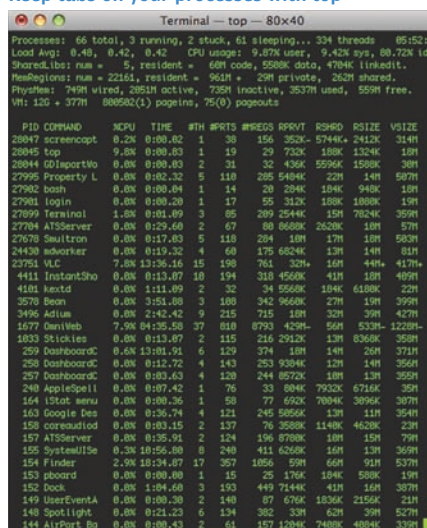
In a terminal window, type defaults write com.apple.screencapture location [path], where the path starts at the root. For example, to save screenshots in your Documents folder, you need to type /Users/[your username]/Documents.

You'll need to log out and log in again

Supercharge your searches with Spotlight hints



Keep tabs on your processes with top



for this to take effect.

Show hidden files

It isn't advisable to show OS X's hidden files for two reasons: firstly, your Finder windows won't look as pretty and uncluttered any more, and secondly, you could end up deleting something critical and messing things up. That said, here's how you enable hidden files:

In a terminal window, type defaults write com.apple.finder AppleShowAllFiles TRUE. You'll need to relaunch Finder for this to work — in the terminal window, type killall Finder (remember the capital F).

Put Automator to Good Use

There's a lot you can do with Automator, but unless you're performing a set of tasks on a regular basis, it's usually better to do them manually — especially if you don't have the time to learn how to use Automator. There are, however, a few tasks we find ourselves doing quite often.

Open folders in a program

This is especially handy if you want to open a single folder of music or video in a program like VLC, so you don't have to add them to your iTunes Library, or if you want to open an entire folder of images in Preview.

To begin with, start Automator. You'll find it under Applications, or just use Spotlight. You'll be prompted to choose a starting point. For now, choose Custom. You'll now go into the main Automator window, with blank workflow just itching to be filled.

The first step is to have Finder identify the folder you've selected. To do this, select

The new Mac Pro comes with an Intel Nehalem-based Xeon processor

Files & Folders under Library (on the left). Look for Get Selected Finder Items, and drag it into the workflow area on the right.

The second step is to have Finder gather all the contents of the folder. Still under Files & Folders, look for Get Folder Contents, and drag it into the workflow area. In the action, choose Repeat for each subfolder found.

Now that you've gathered these items, you're set to open them in the program of your choice. Under Files & Folders, select and drag Open Finder Items into the workflow. You'll now be able to choose the application you want the files to open in.

To test your workflow, open a Finder window, select the folder you want to open, and click Run.

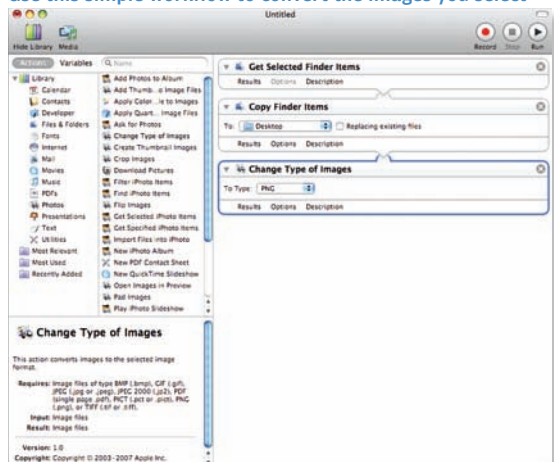
Now, to save this workflow as an item in the right-click menu. Select File > Save as Plug-in and give it a name. You'll now be able to select it by right-clicking on the folder and choosing More > Automator > [Your workflow name].

Convert images in batches

This, too, is a pretty simple workflow — select a bunch of images, and convert them into whatever format you want.

Start with a new Automator workflow ([Cmd] + [N]). Under Files & Folders in the Library, drag Get Selected Finder Items to the workflow area. Now, under Photos, drag Change Type of Images into the workflow. You'll now be asked

Use this simple workflow to convert the images you select



whether you want to add an action to copy the images before you convert them. While you're testing the workflow, we recommend choosing Add. You can remove it once you've had your first success with the workflow.

Finally, choose the type to convert the images to, and you're ready to save the workflow as in the previous tip.